



THE HOUSING INFO STYLE GUIDES

The Mid-Century Modern Style Guide

The details that make the look, and how to recreate it.

WELCOME

A home that feels warm, not like a time capsule

Rich walnut, olive greens, rust and mustard accents, sculptural lighting and bold art. Mid-Century Modern at its best feels warm, nostalgic and beautifully lived-in. Never overly polished, but always intentionally designed.

It looks effortless, but it is not random. Every room follows the same few rules: a warm white backdrop, one dominant wood tone, a tight accent palette, curves and layered light. This guide breaks those rules down into paint colors, materials and simple formulas you can follow room by room.

Use it in order the first time, then come back to the checklists whenever you are ready to tackle the next space.

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

Start with the palette and wood tone, since they tie every room together. Then add built-ins and lighting, and finish with furniture, art and styling. Always sample paint on your own walls before committing.

CONTENTS

The Mid-Century formula	03
The color palette	04
Where each color goes	05
Wood, fabric & texture	06
Wood & built-ins guide	07
Lighting formula	09
Furniture & fabrics	10
Rugs, windows & drapery	11
Room-by-room checklists	12
Where to shop	19
The shopping list	20
Mistakes to avoid	22
The cheat sheet	23



THE LOOK

The Mid-Century formula

Six ingredients show up in every room. Get these right and the rest falls into place.

01

A soft warm-white backdrop

Warm whites with a creamy undertone let walnut and color glow. Never stark, blue or grey white.

02

One rich wood tone

Walnut on built-ins, case pieces, tables and doors. A single dominant wood is what makes the rooms feel warm and cohesive.

03

Olive, rust & mustard

A tight accent palette repeated through cabinetry, upholstery, throws, lamps and art. Earthy, never neon.

04

Sculptural lighting

Paper lanterns, mushroom lamps, globe and layered disc pendants and brass sconces, all glowing warm and low.

05

Curves & mixed textures

A curved bouclé sofa, leather seats, velvet poufs and graphic wool rugs soften all that wood.

06

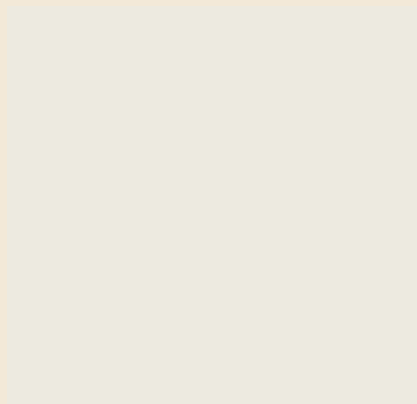
Bold art & collected details

Big abstract art, gallery walls, ceramics, books and plants make it feel gathered over time.

INSIDE THE GUIDE

The color palette

Six colors and finishes do all the work: a soft warm white, olive green, rust, mustard, rich walnut and brass.



WALLS

White Dove

Benjamin Moore OC-17

A soft warm white. The backdrop for walls, trim and ceilings in every room.



CABINETRY

Bancha

Farrow & Ball No. 298

A deep, earthy olive for built-ins, kitchen cabinets and a door.



ACCENT

Baked Clay

Sherwin-Williams SW 6340

A warm rust for an accent wall, a front door or a painted piece.

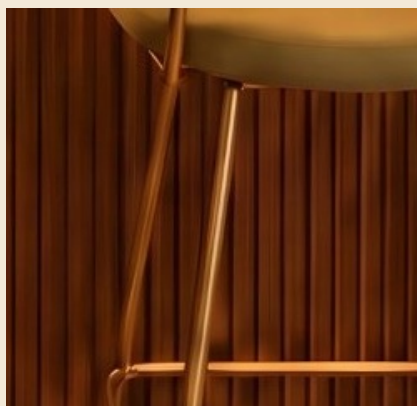


ACCENT

India Yellow

Farrow & Ball No. 66

A golden mustard for a small room, a stool or to match textiles to.



WOOD

Rich Walnut

Minwax Special Walnut 224

The one dominant wood for built-ins, case pieces and tables.



METAL

Aged Brass

Unlacquered finish

For lighting, hardware, stool legs and faucets. Warm and quietly gleaming.

Colors shown are printed or on-screen previews and will vary by device. Always test real samples on your walls in morning and evening light before you paint.

THE PALETTE

Where each color goes

Mid-Century Modern works because every color sits on the same warm undertone as the walnut. Let the warm white do most of the work and use olive, rust and mustard in small, repeated doses.

SURFACE	COLOR	SHEEN	NOTES
Walls	White Dove, BM OC-17	Matte or eggshell	Use eggshell in kitchens and baths for wipeability.
Trim & doors	White Dove, BM OC-17	Satin	Same color as the walls, one sheen up, or stain doors walnut.
Ceilings	White Dove, BM OC-17	Flat	A warm ceiling keeps cove lighting glowing, not grey.
Built-ins & cabinetry	Bancha, F&B 298	Satin	Shelving, a pantry wall, a kitchen run or a bar.
Accent wall or door	Baked Clay, SW 6340	Matte	One wall, a front door or the back of open shelving.
Small accents	India Yellow, F&B 66	Satin	A powder room, a stool or a painted side table.
Wood stain	Special Walnut, Minwax 224	Oil or satin	Match new built-ins and floating shelves to your walnut.

ALSO TRY, WARM WHITES

Sherwin-Williams Alabaster SW 7008 · Benjamin Moore Swiss Coffee OC-45 · Farrow & Ball Pointing No. 2003 · Sherwin-Williams Greek Villa SW 7551

ALSO TRY, OLIVES & RUSTS

Farrow & Ball Olive No. 13 · Farrow & Ball Treron No. 292 · Sherwin-Williams Cavern Clay SW 7701 · Farrow & Ball Red Earth No. 64

DESIGNER TIP

Pair warm walnut with a creamy white, not a bright white. It keeps wood tones rich instead of orange. Test large samples next to your wood and check them at 9am and 7pm.

MATERIALS

Wood, fabric & texture

Warm wood, soft curves and a little gleam are exactly what keep these rooms cozy instead of retro.



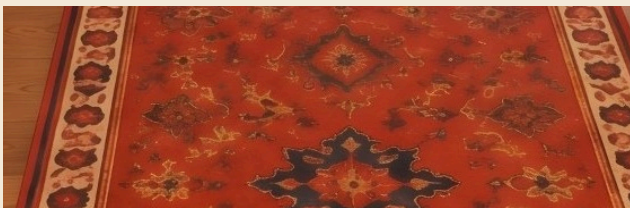
Wood: rich walnut

- ◆ Walnut or walnut-stained wood for built-ins, case pieces, tables and doors.
- ◆ Slatted and fluted walnut on an island, headboard or wall panel adds rhythm.
- ◆ Keep one dominant wood. Teak and light oak work as small accents only.



Fabric: bouclé, velvet & leather

- ◆ Cream bouclé on a curved sofa or lounge chair, the softest note in the room.
- ◆ Olive velvet on an armchair, poufs or bar stools for depth.
- ◆ Cognac or black leather on dining seats and an office chair; it only gets better.



Rugs: vintage & graphic wool

- ◆ Red and navy vintage Persian runners in entries, kitchens and baths.
- ◆ Cream wool with a small black square or Moroccan pattern in living rooms and bedrooms.
- ◆ Mix one vintage pattern with one graphic rug per sightline, not more.



Light: paper, glass & brass

- ◆ White paper lanterns and pleated shades for soft, diffused light.
- ◆ Glossy orange or coral mushroom lamps as color moments.
- ◆ Aged brass sconces and stool legs; avoid chrome and cool polished nickel.

WOOD & BUILT-INS GUIDE

Adding character to a plain room

Built-ins, wood details and warm light are what make these rooms feel designed. Here is how to add them, even to a builder-grade home. Costs below are rough ranges and vary by region and home.

01

Walnut built-in shelving

Floor-to-ceiling shelving with lower cabinets on one wall gives a plain room instant character and a place for books and ceramics.

DIY (IKEA base + walnut veneer): \$800 to \$2,500 · **Pro:** \$4,000 to \$12,000

Add LED strips under each shelf for a warm glow.

02

Slatted wood details

Vertical walnut slats on an island, a headboard wall or a media wall add the signature mid-century rhythm.

DIY slat panels: \$25 to \$60 per sq ft · **Pro:** \$60 to \$120 per sq ft

Acoustic slat panels install with adhesive and screws.

03

Olive cabinetry

Repaint existing cabinets or built-ins in Bancha for a rich, earthy contrast to walnut and warm white walls.

DIY: \$200 to \$600 · **Pro:** \$3,000 to \$7,000 for a kitchen
Degrease, sand and prime; use a cabinet-grade enamel.

04

Cove & tray ceiling light

A shallow tray or cove with warm LED tape washes the ceiling with soft light, like the rooms in this guide.

DIY LED tape in crown: \$150 to \$400 per room · **Pro tray:** \$2,000 to \$6,000

Use 2700K tape on a dimmer.

WHERE TO START

If you only do one thing, add a run of walnut shelving with lower cabinets to your living room or hallway. It is the single biggest change for the money.

WOOD & BUILT-INS GUIDE

Details that finish the shell

Once the big moves are done, these smaller upgrades carry the look into every corner.

- ◆ **Warm wood floors.** Mid-tone oak or walnut-toned planks in a matte finish. Skip grey and whitewashed floors.
- ◆ **Slab and flat-panel doors.** Simple fronts in walnut or olive, with no ornate profiles or raised panels.
- ◆ **Brass hardware.** Peg knobs, slim bar pulls and cup pulls in aged brass tie wood to lighting.
- ◆ **Warm square tile.** Cream square or zellige-style tile behind the range and in the bath.
- ◆ **Wood blinds and linen.** Wood venetian blinds or sheer linen keep light warm and filtered.
- ◆ **Arched mirrors.** A tall arched walnut mirror in the entry or bath softens all the straight lines.

DESIGNER TIP

Keep walls and trim warm white throughout the home and let the walnut and olive built-ins carry the color. Save rust and mustard for objects you can change.



LIGHTING FORMULA

Sculptural, warm and low

Paper lanterns, mushroom lamps, globe pendants and brass sconces do the heavy lifting. Use at least three light sources at different heights in every room for that warm evening glow.

2700K

BULB COLOR TEMPERATURE

90+

CRI FOR TRUE COLORS

3+

LIGHT SOURCES PER ROOM

FIXTURE	HOW BIG	HOW HIGH
Dining pendant	About half the table's width; a layered disc or globe shade	30 to 34 inches above the tabletop
Paper lantern	20 to 30 inches across in a living room; go bigger than you think	At least 7 ft clear of the floor
Island pendants	12 to 16 inches each; 2 or 3 over the island	30 to 36 inches above the counter
Wall sconces	Scaled to the mirror, shelf or art they flank	60 to 66 inches from the floor to center
Mushroom lamps	10 to 16 inches tall on consoles, desks and nightstands	Shade near eye level when seated
Floor lanterns	4 to 5 ft paper or pleated column beside a lounge chair	In a corner or beside a window

CHOOSE

White paper and pleated shades, glossy orange mushroom lamps, layered disc pendants and aged brass sconces.

PUT EVERYTHING ON DIMMERS

Dimmed, warm light at night is what gives these rooms their glow. Add warm LED strips under shelves and in coves.

FURNITURE & FABRICS

Curves, wood and leather

The mix is what keeps it fresh: soft curves, warm wood, leather and a few bold color moments.

60% WARM WHITE & CREAM

30% WALNUT

10% ACCENTS

- ◆ **Sofas:** a curved or rounded silhouette in cream bouclé or textured weave, low and deep.
- ◆ **Accent chairs:** a wood-frame lounge chair in olive or an olive velvet armchair.
- ◆ **Wood:** walnut credenzas, round pedestal tables and tapered legs. One wood tone, repeated.
- ◆ **Mix eras:** at least one of every three pieces should be vintage or vintage-inspired, never a matching set.
- ◆ **Fabrics:** bouclé, velvet, leather and knit throws in rust and mustard. Pattern comes from rugs, pillows and art.
- ◆ **Scale:** leave 18 inches between a sofa and coffee table, and 30 to 36 inches for walkways.

COLLECTED, NOT RETRO

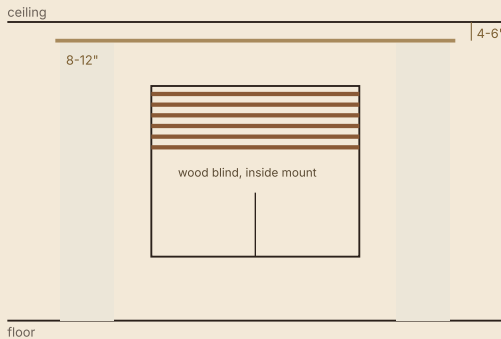
Too many matching vintage pieces and it tips into a time capsule. Mix in modern upholstery and a few new pieces so it feels lived in today.

RUGS, WINDOWS & DRAPERY

Warm, filtered and grounded

These rooms glow because light is filtered through wood and linen, and every zone is anchored by a rug. These simple numbers make ceilings look taller and rooms feel finished.

Window & drapery rules



- ◆ Mount the rod 4 to 6 inches below the ceiling, or halfway between the window top and ceiling.
- ◆ Extend the rod 8 to 12 inches past the frame on each side.
- ◆ Layer wood blinds inside the frame with sheer linen panels outside it.
- ◆ Fabric width 2 to 2.5 times the window width; let panels kiss the floor.
- ◆ Sheer white or oatmeal linen on a slim brass or wood rod.

Rug rules

ROOM	RULE OF THUMB
Living	Cream graphic wool or Moroccan-style rug; all front legs on it.
Dining	24 to 30 inches beyond the table on all sides; round rug under a round table.
Bedroom	18 to 24 inches showing on each side of the bed.
Entry & hall	A vintage runner with 4 to 6 inches of floor showing on each side.
Kitchen & bath	A red or rust vintage runner in front of the sink or vanity.

LOOK FOR

Vintage Persian runners in red, rust and navy, and cream wool rugs with small black squares or Moroccan motifs. Go bigger than feels natural.



ROOM 01 · THE ENTRY

A collected passage

Walnut built-ins line the hall, with an arched mirror, an orange mushroom lamp, an olive velvet pouf and a red vintage runner on warm wood floors. Vintage-inspired color and practical pieces give the hallway personality.

THE FORMULA

01 Line it with storage

Walnut cabinets and open shelves along one side hold shoes, books and baskets, and make a narrow hall feel built-in.

02 Add a slim console

A wall-hung walnut console or desk, 12 to 16 inches deep, gives you a landing spot without blocking the path.

03 Ground it with a runner

A red vintage runner with 4 to 6 inches of floor on each side makes the hallway feel finished.

04 Make one color moment

An orange mushroom lamp, olive velvet poufs and a graphic print set the palette for the whole home.

DESIGNER TIP

Use the hallway for one bold color moment, like a runner or a lamp. It sets the tone for the whole home in a few steps.

SKIP THIS

A bare hallway with a ceiling light only. Add a lamp, a mirror and a runner so the first impression feels warm.

CHECKLIST

☐ Walls White Dove☐ Walnut built-in storage☐ Slim walnut console☐ Arched walnut mirror☐ Orange mushroom lamp☐ Red vintage runner

SHOP THE LOOK · LINKS ON PAGE 20

Flowerpot VP9 lamp · Williams walnut mirror · Layla runner · Seno sideboard · glass vases



ROOM 02 · THE LIVING ROOM

An evening lounge

A fireplace anchors the room, flanked by olive built-ins. A cream sofa, rust throws, an olive velvet armchair and a vintage rug make it the place to unwind.

THE FORMULA

01 Anchor the seating

Face a cream sofa toward the fireplace and close the circle with an olive armchair, keeping seating within 8 to 10 feet.

02 Flank with built-ins

Olive or walnut shelving on both sides of the fireplace frames it and gives books and ceramics a home.

03 Layer the light

A paper lantern overhead, table lamps at seated height, picture lights on shelves and candles on the mantel.

04 Add warmth in textiles

Rust and mustard throws, patterned pillows and a vintage rug make it cozy rather than formal.

DESIGNER TIP

Use at least three light sources at different heights, like lamps, sconces and candles, for that warm evening glow.

SKIP THIS

A matched sofa and loveseat set. Mix a curved sofa with a wood-frame chair so it looks collected.

CHECKLIST

☐ Cream curved sofa☐ Olive velvet armchair☐ Built-ins beside the fireplace☐ Paper lantern pendant☐ Rust and mustard throws☐ Vintage or graphic wool rug

SHOP THE LOOK · LINKS ON PAGE 20

Curvo sofa · Show Wood chair · round coffee table · Akari 45A · chenille throw

ROOM 03 · THE DINING ROOM

Made for gathering

A round walnut pedestal table, bentwood chairs with leather seats and a sculptural pendant overhead, backed by olive-green cabinetry and open shelves full of books and ceramics.

THE FORMULA

01 Go round and wooden

A round walnut pedestal table is easy to move around and seats more people in a small space.

02 Hang a sculptural pendant

A layered disc or globe pendant about half the table's width, 30 to 34 inches above the top.

03 Back it with color

Olive cabinetry or shelving behind the table adds depth and storage for dishes, books and ceramics.

04 Mix your seating

Wood chairs with leather seats are durable and warm; add a bench or banquette if space allows.

DESIGNER TIP

Hang the pendant 30 to 34 inches above the table. A round table with a round shade keeps the room soft and easy to move around.

SKIP THIS

A tiny pendant over a big table. Go bigger than you think so the light reads as a sculpture.

CHECKLIST

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Round walnut pedestal table | ☐ Wood chairs with leather seats |
| ☐ Layered disc pendant | ☐ Olive built-in cabinets |
| ☐ Round or cream rug | ☐ Flowers in a ceramic vase |

SHOP THE LOOK · LINKS ON PAGE 20

Conan table · Sede chair · PH5 pendant · Barro bowl · glass vases



ROOM 04 · THE KITCHEN

A welcoming kitchen

Walnut cabinetry, creamy counters and a slatted island with warm under-cabinet light. Olive bar stools and a vintage runner soften the everyday.

THE FORMULA

01 Walnut and cream

Walnut cabinetry with creamy counters and square cream tile keeps the kitchen warm, not dark.

02 Slat the island

Vertical walnut slats with a warm LED strip under the overhang make the island the centerpiece.

03 Seat it in olive

Olive velvet or leather stools with slim brass legs tie the kitchen to the rest of the palette.

04 Open up a few shelves

A run of open walnut shelves with orange and cream ceramics adds color you can change.

DESIGNER TIP

Pair warm walnut with a creamy white, not a bright white. It keeps wood tones rich instead of orange.

SKIP THIS

Stark white quartz and chrome. Choose creamy counters, warm tile and brass so the wood looks rich.

CHECKLIST

☐ Walnut cabinetry

☐ Creamy counters and tile

☐ Slatted walnut island

☐ Olive stools with brass legs

☐ Under-cabinet warm light

☐ Vintage runner

SHOP THE LOOK · LINKS ON PAGE 20

Dekum pendant · swivel counter stool · peg cabinet knob · Layla runner · Barro bowl

ROOM 05 · THE OFFICE

A focused corner

A long walnut desk by the window, an olive leather chair, lit walnut shelving and an orange mushroom lamp make working from home feel warm and intentional.

THE FORMULA

01 Face the light

Place the desk along or facing a window, never with your back to it, and add wood blinds to control glare.

02 Build in the storage

Walnut shelving and lower cabinets on one wall keep files hidden and books, art and objects on display.

03 Choose a chair you love

An olive leather or upholstered task chair looks like furniture, not office equipment.

04 Light it like a lounge

A mushroom desk lamp, a paper table lamp and warm shelf lighting on dimmers.

DESIGNER TIP

Style shelves in thirds: books, one ceramic or brass object, then breathing room. Lean a framed print against the back.

SKIP THIS

A white plastic desk and a mesh office chair. Choose walnut and leather that belong in the rest of the home.

CHECKLIST

☐ Long walnut desk

☐ Olive leather task chair

☐ Walnut shelving with lighting

☐ Orange mushroom lamp

☐ Wood blinds

☐ Graphic cream wool rug

SHOP THE LOOK · LINKS ON PAGE 20

Cabinet Maker's picture light · Luis table lamp · Flowerpot VP9 lamp · Lyons rug · Sienna print

ROOM 06 · THE BEDROOM

A softer retreat

A walnut dresser and nightstands, a cream bed layered with a rust throw and patterned pillows, an orange mushroom lamp and a gallery wall of floral art. Warm, layered and restful.

THE FORMULA

01 Keep the bed soft

A cream upholstered bed with white linen keeps the room calm against all the walnut.

02 Layer in rust

A rust throw across the foot, red and patterned pillows, and one mustard accent.

03 Walnut case pieces

Low walnut nightstands and a long dresser with tapered legs give the room its mid-century bones.

04 Hang a gallery wall

A mix of floral prints and one large painting above the bed, framed in wood and brass.

DESIGNER TIP

Repeat one accent color, like rust, in three places: bedding, a lamp and art. It ties the room together without looking matched.

SKIP THIS

Matching bedroom sets. Mix a cream upholstered bed with walnut case pieces for a collected feel.

CHECKLIST

☐ Cream upholstered bed

☐ Rust throw and red pillows

☐ Walnut nightstands and dresser

☐ Orange mushroom lamp

☐ Floral gallery wall

☐ Cream graphic wool rug

SHOP THE LOOK · LINKS ON PAGE 20

Calabri bed · Liv nightstand · Flowerpot VP9 lamp · Lyons rug · sheer linen curtain

ROOM 07 · THE BATH

A calm bath

A walnut vanity with a stone top, brass sconces beside an arched mirror, landscape art and a vintage rug carry the home's warmth into the bathroom.

THE FORMULA

01 Treat the vanity like furniture

A walnut vanity on legs with a stone top and brass hardware feels custom and warm.

02 Light for your face

Brass sconces with pleated shades on each side of the mirror at about 66 inches.

03 Warm the hard surfaces

Cream square tile, a vintage runner and walnut accents keep it from feeling clinical.

04 Add art and greenery

A small landscape painting and a potted plant make the bath feel like part of the home.

DESIGNER TIP

Mount sconces on either side of the mirror at about eye level, roughly 66 inches, for the most flattering light.

SKIP THIS

Cool white tile and chrome. Choose cream tile, brass and 2700K bulbs so the room glows instead of glares.

CHECKLIST

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Walnut furniture-style vanity | ☐ Stone vanity top |
| ☐ Arched mirror | ☐ Brass sconces at 66 inches |
| ☐ Cream square tile | ☐ Vintage runner and art |

SHOP THE LOOK · LINKS ON PAGE 20

Allenglade sconce · Williams mirror · Layla runner · peg cabinet knob · glass vases

CURATED SHOPPING

Where to shop the look

Mix a few investment pieces with vintage finds and affordable basics. These are the go-to sources for each category, from splurge to save.

CATEGORY	SPLURGE	MID-RANGE	SAVE & VINTAGE
Lighting	Louis Poulsen, Noguchi Akari, DWR	Rejuvenation, Schoolhouse, Lulu and Georgia	Target, IKEA, vintage on Chairish
Rugs	Nordic Knots, Beni Rugs	Loloi, West Elm, Lulu and Georgia	Ruggable, vintage runners on Etsy
Upholstery	Design Within Reach, Lawson-Fenning	Article, CB2, West Elm	Burrow, Castlery, Marketplace
Wood & vintage	1stDibs, Design Within Reach	Article, Floyd, West Elm	Chairish, AptDeco, estate sales
Art & frames	Tappan, Saatchi Art, Uprise Art	Juniper Print Shop, Minted, Framebridge	Society6, Etsy prints, thrifted frames
Hardware	Buster + Punch, Waterworks	Rejuvenation, Schoolhouse	Amerock, solid brass on Etsy
Drapery & shades	The Shade Store, Loom Decor	West Elm, Crate & Barrel	IKEA, Target, H&M Home linen
Paint	Farrow & Ball, Portola Paints	Benjamin Moore, Sherwin-Williams, Backdrop	Color-matched samples at your local store

SEARCH TERMS THAT WORK

"vintage walnut credenza" · "mid century lounge chair" · "mushroom table lamp" · "paper lantern pendant" · "vintage persian runner" · "boucle curved sofa" · "amber glass vase"

VINTAGE SHOPPING TIP

Buy the case pieces vintage and the upholstery new. Solid walnut dressers and credenzas last forever; old foam and fabric rarely do.

THE SHOPPING LIST

Shop the rooms

Every piece below was chosen to recreate the rooms in this guide, from trusted sources like Article, West Elm, Rejuvenation, Design Within Reach and the Noguchi Museum Shop.

LIGHTING

Akari 45A Pendant Noguchi Museum Shop	Living room	\$350	SHOP shop.noguchi.org
PH5 Pendant Lamp Design Within Reach	Dining room	\$1,365	SHOP dwr.com
Flowerpot VP9 Portable Lamp, Zesty Orange &Tradition, Finnish Design Shop	Entry & bedroom	\$315	SHOP finnishdesignshop.com
Akari 10A Floor Lamp Noguchi Museum Shop	Living room	\$700	SHOP shop.noguchi.org
Allenglade Single Sconce Rejuvenation	Bath & bedroom	\$369–\$759	SHOP rejuvenation.com
Cabinet Maker's Picture Light Rejuvenation	Living room & office	\$399–\$799	SHOP rejuvenation.com
Dekum 16" Metal Dome Pendant Rejuvenation	Kitchen island	\$879–\$999	SHOP rejuvenation.com
Luis Table Lamp Lulu and Georgia	Bedroom & office	\$198	SHOP luluandgeorgia.com

FURNITURE

Curvo 96.5" Sofa, Bloce Cream CB2	Living room	\$2,759	SHOP cb2.com
Mid-Century Show Wood Chair West Elm	Living room	See site	SHOP westelm.com
Mid-Century Round Coffee Table West Elm	Living room	\$599	SHOP westelm.com
Seno 71" Sideboard, Walnut Article	Dining & entry	\$1,199	SHOP article.com
Conan 54" Round Dining Table, Walnut Article	Dining room	\$599	SHOP article.com

THE SHOPPING LIST · CONTINUED

Shop the rooms

Furniture, rugs, curtains, art and the finishing hardware that pull every room together.

FURNITURE

Sede Leather Dining Chair Article	Dining room	\$299	SHOP article.com
Mid-Century Swivel Counter Stool West Elm	Kitchen island	\$399–\$549	SHOP westelm.com
Calabri Queen Bed, Ivory Wool Bouclé Article	Bedroom	\$1,599	SHOP article.com
Liv 1-Drawer Nightstand, Walnut Article	Bedroom	\$349	SHOP article.com

RUGS & TEXTILES

Lyons Moroccan-Style Wool Rug Lulu and Georgia	Living & bedroom	\$179–\$1,349	SHOP luluandgeorgia.com
Layla LAY-08 Runner, Red / Navy Loloi	Entry, kitchen & bath	See site	SHOP loloirugs.com
Chenille Knit Throw, Gold Threshold, Target	Living room	\$20	SHOP target.com
Sheer European Flax Linen Curtain West Elm	Every room	\$99–\$238	SHOP westelm.com

DECOR & HARDWARE

Foundations Glass Vases West Elm	Every room	From \$11	SHOP westelm.com
Sienna, abstract art print Juniper Print Shop	Living room	\$20–\$299	SHOP juniperprintshop.com
Mid-Century Peg Cabinet Knob Rejuvenation	Kitchen & built-ins	\$15	SHOP rejuvenation.com
Williams Wall Mirror, Walnut Article	Entry & bath	\$249	SHOP article.com
Barro Salad Bowl HAY, Design Within Reach	Dining & kitchen	\$39	SHOP dwr.com

Prices and availability were checked in October 2026 and may change. Every item is a designer pick chosen to complete the look. Tap any item name or Shop to open it.

WHY YOU CAN'T JUST COPY A PHOTO

Mistakes to avoid

Saving inspiration is easy. Getting it to look right in your own home is the hard part. These are the most common places it goes wrong.

01

Trusting screen colors

A warm white on your phone can turn grey, yellow or pink on your walls. Use real paint codes and sample them.

02

Getting the accents wrong

Olive, rust and mustard look rich or dated depending on the shade. Choose warm, earthy versions that sit beside walnut.

03

Mixing too many woods

Walnut, oak, pine and cherry in one room feels busy. Keep one dominant wood and use others sparingly.

04

Going full time capsule

Too many matching vintage pieces feels like a period set. Mix eras and add a few new pieces.

05

Bright white everything

Stark white walls and counters make walnut look orange. Use a creamy white instead.

06

Cool or mixed metals

Chrome and matte black fight the warmth. Stick with aged brass and a little black on lamps.

07

Getting scale wrong

Small rugs, short curtains and tiny pendants make a room feel unfinished. Follow the numbers in this guide.

08

Relying on overheads

A single ceiling light flattens everything. Add lamps, sconces and shelf lighting on dimmers.

KEEP THIS HANDY

The cheat sheet

Every number in one place. Screenshot it, print it or save it to your phone before you shop.

COLOR & FINISH

Walls & trim	White Dove BM OC-17
Cabinetry	Bancha F&B 298
Accent	Baked Clay SW 6340
Accent	India Yellow F&B 66
Wood stain	Special Walnut Minwax 224
Metal	Aged brass, unlacquered

LIGHTING

Bulbs	2700K, CRI 90+, dimmable
Dining pendant	30 to 34" above table
Island pendants	30 to 36" above counter
Sconces	60 to 66" to center

WINDOWS & RUGS

Curtain rod	4 to 6" below ceiling
Rod overhang	8 to 12" each side
Panel fullness	2 to 2.5x window width
Blinds	Wood, inside mount
Living rug	All front legs on it
Dining rug	24 to 30" past the table
Bedroom rug	18 to 24" each side

ART & BUILT-INS

Art over furniture	About 2/3 its width
Art above headboard	8 to 10"
Built-in shelves	12 to 14" deep
Console depth	12 to 16"
Accent colors	Repeat each 3 times



THANK YOU

Bring the look home

Start with the palette and one rich wood tone, add built-ins and sculptural light, and collect slowly. Your home does not need to be finished in a weekend to feel beautiful.

Want a designer's eye on your own rooms? Housing Info offers virtual design packages with a custom plan, shopping links and visual mockups. Send us a message on Instagram to get started.

@HOUSINGINFO